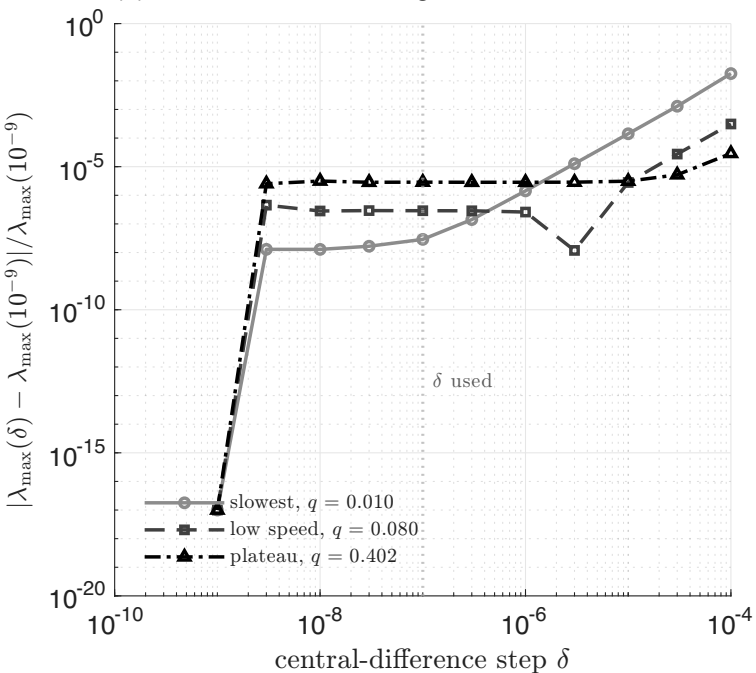


(a) finite-difference convergence



(b) reduction and structural zero, along the branch

